How I Build Products with AI

A structured workflow for non-technical builders

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The Challenge

Non-technical PMs can now build with AI — but many are vibe coding without a process.

No Code Review

AI writes code, nobody checks it. Bugs ship to production.

No Planning

Jump straight to building. Complex features break because nobody thought through architecture.

No Learning

Copy-paste AI output without understanding what was built or why.

Three Modes of Working with AI

Conversational

Ask questions, learn concepts, get explanations. No tools needed — just chat.

Thinking Partner

A CTO in a chat project. Debate architecture, challenge ideas, plan before building.

Build Pipeline

Structured /commands in Cursor + Claude Code. Explore → Plan → Execute → Review → Ship.

The Setup

Two files power the entire workflow

CLAUDE.md

The system prompt Claude reads every session. Defines roles, workflow, conventions, and learnings. This is where the 'CTO personality' lives.

/commands

10 reusable markdown files, each mapped to a workflow phase:

`/exploration-phase` `/create-plan`

`/execute-plan` `/review`

`/peer-review` `/postmortem`

`/update-docs` `/create-issue`

The Workflow

Six phases. Each one has a dedicated /command.

Explore → **Plan** → **Execute** → **Review** → **Peer Review** → **Postmortem**

Explore	Plan	Execute	Review	Peer Review	Postmortem
`/exploration`	`/create-plan`	`/execute-plan`	`/review`	`/peer-review`	`/postmortem`

Phase 0: Research

Study how experienced practitioners work, then adapt their techniques.

01

Study Practitioners

Research how non-technical builders are shipping real products with AI tools

02

Extract Patterns

Feed transcripts and notes to Claude as a thinking partner. Identify the underlying workflow principles.

03

Build Your Toolkit

Create CLAUDE.md + /commands scaffold based on extracted patterns. Customize for your style.

04

Iterate & Evolve

Each project refines the process. Postmortems feed back into the toolkit.

Phase 1: Exploration

Before writing any code — define the scope through structured Q&A.

Claude (CTO) Does:

- Analyzes the codebase
- Presents its understanding back
- Asks 12 clarifying questions
- Organized by: scope, data model, UX, validation

I (Product Owner) Do:

- Answer every question as PM
- Make scope decisions
- Define what "done" looks like
- Set constraints and priorities

Phases 2–3: Plan & Execute

/create-plan

Claude generates a markdown plan:

- TLDR (one-paragraph summary)
- Critical decisions table
- Phased tasks with priorities
- Risks & mitigations

I review before approving.

/execute-plan

Claude builds the feature:

- Follows the approved plan
- Updates task status as it builds
- Handles file creation, testing
- Claude builds from the approved plan

This is the only phase where code is written.

Phases 4–5: Review & Peer Review

Multiple AI models review the code. Claude evaluates as dev lead.

Self Review /review

6	2	5
Issues	Critical	Auto-Fixed

Peer Review /peer-review

Accepted & Fixed: 6
Accepted & Deferred: 1
Rejected: 1

> *"Composer caught things I should have caught myself — especially the end-time auto-adjust right after a postmortem about that exact pattern." — Claude's self-assessment*

Process: Get review from Cursor Composer → Paste into /peer-review → Claude evaluates as dev lead

Phase 6: Postmortem

The workflow gets continuously smarter after every session.

1

Find a Bug

Manual testing caught a time validation edge case that /review missed

2

Ask Why

"What in your tooling made you miss this?" Claude reflects on the root cause

3

Update Tooling

Claude updates its own /review command and CLAUDE.md with the lesson

4

Never Again

Every future /review session now checks for interdependent form fields

The Result

1

Day to Build
& Deploy

10

Reusable
/Commands

0

Lines of Code
Manually Written

Key Takeaways

- The process is the differentiator, not the output
- You own the product decisions. AI implements technical decisions under your direction.
- Multi-model peer review catches what self-review misses
- The postmortem habit makes your workflow continuously smarter
- Anyone can replicate this — it's just markdown files

Start Building

The best time to start was yesterday.
The second best time is now.

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